FIELD MANUAL · ANDROID 13 AND NEWER

Keeping your SMS gateway app awake, 24 hours a day, 7 days a week

Exact tap-by-tap instructions for six kinds of phone — Samsung, Xiaomi, Oppo/Realme, Vivo, Google Pixel, and any other Android 13/14 handset. Written for the person who owns the phone. No technical knowledge assumed.

WHY

Android quietly stops background apps to save battery. Your gateway is exactly the kind of app it stops first.

WHAT YOU NEED

The phone, the SIM, and about 20 minutes per brand section. Nothing to buy.

HOW TO USE

Read Section 0 first — it protects every brand. Then find your phone's brand and work through only that section.

⚠ Read this before you touch anything

Your phone is meant to kill background apps. That is a feature to the phone maker, and a bug to you — the OTP never goes out and nobody notices for hours. Every setting below exists to switch that off for this one app.

Two warnings up front. First, some steps only exist on your app if it was installed from an APK file rather than the Play Store. If a permission button is greyed out, Section 0 has the fix. Second, if your app can act as the phone's messaging app, setting it as the default is the single most protective thing you can do — it makes Android treat the app as essential rather than as a leftover.

Menu names in this guide are the actual words on the screen, in the actual order. Brand names and button labels differ between models, regions and software versions, so where two names are in use both are given. If a screen simply isn't there, your phone's version does not have it — skip that step, it does not apply to you.

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> **Do Section 0 first, whichever phone you own.** It covers the settings that matter on every Android phone, including the one that silences your app after a few months of you never opening it. The brand sections then add the extra traps each manufacturer adds on top.

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APPLIES TO EVERY PHONE · ANDROID 13 AND NEWER

Start here — the settings that protect every phone

Whichever brand you own, do these **five steps first**. They are the settings Android itself uses to decide whether an app matters. A brand section then adds the extras that only that manufacturer does.

1 Keep the phone plugged into a charger, permanently

2 MINUTES

This is the single most reliable trick in this whole guide, and it is free. Android's main "go to sleep" mode — the one that stops apps working when the screen is off — is documented as **not engaging at all while the device is plugged into a power charger**. Your gateway phone is a dedicated device with a SIM in it; keeping it on a USB adapter or a charging pad removes the largest cause of delayed OTPs overnight.

- [ ] **1.1** Put the phone on a charger and leave it there. A wall plug with a USB cable is fine, or a charging pad. If the battery is allowed to drain to zero and the phone sits unplugged for hours overnight, the sleep behaviour returns.

  `Settings → Battery → Battery charging / Charging settings`

  Then switch off **Adaptive charging** or **Charging optimisation** if such a switch exists, so the phone stays at full power overnight instead of pausing the charge at 80%.

- [ ] **1.2** **Optional but recommended:** keep the screen on a dim screensaver instead of off, **or** leave the phone on a desk where it is picked up now and then. A phone that gets moved is treated as active and is far less likely to be frozen. Some kiosk setups also set **Settings → Display → Screen timeout → Never**.

> **Why the phone is going to sleep in the first place**
>
> Android has several separate mechanisms, and phone makers add more on top. They do not all use the same words, which is why guides disagree. Here is the plain version:
>
> - **Doze** — the built-in sleep mode. Restricts network and alarms when the phone is idle, screen off and unplugged. Fixed by keeping the phone charged.
> - **App Standby** — Android sorts apps into buckets by how much you use them. An app you never open gets put in the "Rare" or "Never" bucket and is throttled. Fixed by setting the app to Unrestricted.
> - **App hibernation** — after a few months of never opening an app, Android *force-stops it, wipes its permissions, and stops it showing notifications*. This is the one that will get you months from now.
> - **Brand killers** — Samsung's sleeping apps, Xiaomi's Autostart, ColorOS's standby optimisation. These are Section 1 to 4.

2 Make the app the phone's default messaging app

THE STRONGEST SINGLE PROTECTION

If your gateway app is able to act as a messaging app, make it the default one. This is worth doing before anything else, because Android treats a default messaging app as essential in a way it never treats an ordinary app. Two real effects: the app is granted its SMS permissions **because of the role it holds**, and Android's automatic "revoke permissions from apps you never use" routine explicitly **skips permissions granted by a role**. So the default-app route protects the app from the slow-motion permission theft described in step 3.

- [ ] **2.1** Open the gateway app once. Most apps of this type show a prompt like **Set as default** or **Make this your default SMS app**. If one appears, tap it and confirm.

  `Gateway app → Set as default → Set default SMS app`

- [ ] **2.2** **If no prompt appeared,** set it by hand. The words differ slightly by brand:

PIXEL, GENERIC ANDROID	`Settings → Apps → Default apps → SMS app → tap your gateway app`
SAMSUNG ONE UI 6+	`Settings → Apps → Choose default apps → SMS app → tap your gateway app`
XIAOMI, OPPO/REALME, VIVO	`Settings → Apps → Default apps → SMS app → tap your gateway app` `On some of these builds the list is called Choose default apps, or it sits under the three-dot menu at the top of the Apps screen.`

- [ ] **2.3** **Important:** if the phone's usual messaging app is currently the default, you are about to replace it. That is usually what you want on a dedicated gateway phone, and the stock messaging app remains installed and can be set back at any time through the same menu. On Samsung, the stock option may be listed as **Google Messages** rather than "Samsung Messages".

- [ ] **2.4** **If your app cannot be a messaging app** (some gateways only send, or only talk to a server and never read the SMS app), skip this step. It is not harmful, just not available. Everything else in this guide still applies.

> ⚠ **A note on incoming messages, for the curious**
>
> Since Android 4.4, only the phone's default messaging app receives the full incoming message. Other apps still receive a "something arrived" broadcast, which is enough for reading a verification code, but not the same thing. If your gateway also has to *receive* OTPs, becoming the default messaging app is close to essential rather than merely helpful. This is the reason to prefer a dedicated phone for a gateway: the phone's whole job is to be that default app.

3 Stop Android from pausing the app when you do not use it

DO THIS OR IT WILL HAPPEN IN A FEW MONTHS

This is the step people miss, and it is the one that causes the "it worked for four months and then it just stopped" failure. A dedicated gateway phone is barely ever opened, so Android decides the app is unused. After roughly three months, Android **hibernates** it: it force-stops the app, resets its permissions, and stops it being able to post notifications. Your SIM keeps working; your app is now a stranger on the phone. Turning this off is a single switch.

- [ ] **3.1** Open the app's info screen — long-press its icon and tap **App info**, or go to **Settings → Apps → See all apps** and tap the app.

  ```
  Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app
  ```

- [ ] **3.2** Scroll to the bottom of that screen. Under the heading **Unused app settings**, turn **off** the switch named below. The wording depends on the Android version:

ANDROID 13, 14, 15, 16	**Pause app activity if unused** — turn this OFF. (On Samsung the same switch may read **Remove permissions if app is unused**.)
ANDROID 12	**Remove permissions and free up space** — turn this OFF.
ANDROID 11	Tap **Permissions** first, then turn off **Remove permissions if app isn't used**.

- [ ] **3.3** **Also switch off the "unused permissions" cleaner**, which is a separate switch that quietly revokes the SMS permission on its own schedule. In the same **Permissions** screen, look for a three-dot menu at the top right and choose **Unused permissions**, or a switch called **Auto-remove permissions** / **Automatically remove permissions**, and turn it **off**.

- [ ] **3.4** **Safety habit:** even with the switch off, open the gateway app once a month or so. It costs ten seconds and it resets the "unused" clock, which is the belt-and-braces version of the same fix.

4 If you installed the app yourself (APK file), unlock the hidden permission switches

ANDROID 13+ ONLY

Since Android 13, Android deliberately locks down certain permissions for apps that were not installed from the Play Store — apps loaded from an APK file you downloaded, or from F-Droid, or sideloaded yourself. The switch is still there, but greyed out, and tapping it says **"Restricted setting — For your security, this setting is currently unavailable."** This catches almost every self-built SMS gateway, and it is the reason some people's SMS permission simply will not turn on.

- [ ] **4.1** **First, try the permission you want** — go to the app's info screen, tap **Permissions**, tap the greyed-out permission (usually **SMS** or **Phone and messages**) and turn it on. It will refuse, and show the "Restricted setting" message. Tap **OK** to dismiss it. This step is required — the unlock option is invisible until Android has seen you try.

- [ ] **4.2** Go back to the app's info screen and tap the three-dot menu in the top right corner.

  ```
  Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → ⋮ (top right)
  ```

- [ ] **4.3** Choose **Allow restricted settings**. Confirm with your PIN, pattern or fingerprint.

- [ ] **4.4** Now go back to **Permissions** and turn the SMS permission on properly. It will stick this time.

> ⚠ **This matters much more on Android 15 and 16**
>
> On Android 15 and 16 the restricted list was widened, and **SMS itself is now on it**. A sideloaded gateway on a Pixel 15 or a modern Xiaomi cannot have **SEND SMS** or **RECEIVE SMS** until you do the unlock above. Without it the permission switch is dead grey and simply refuses. Some builds also hide the "Allow restricted settings" menu item entirely until you have triggered the refusal once, exactly as described in step 4.1.
>
> On Android 15 the unlock also covers the default messaging app role, so do step 4 **before** step 2 if your phone runs Android 15 or newer.

5 Silence the interruptions that mute your app

2 MINUTES

If a mode such as Do Not Disturb, Bedtime, Driving or Focus mode is on, notifications from your app are suppressed — and on some builds, so is its ability to wake the phone. On a device that exists only to send messages, every one of these should be off.

- [ ] **5.1** Turn off Do Not Disturb and check its schedule. Pull down from the top of the screen to see the quick settings tiles.

  ```
  Swipe down from top → Do Not Disturb → Turn off now
  On Android 14 and newer, full control is at Settings → Modes → Do Not Disturb. On Android 13,
  Settings → Sound & vibration → Do Not Disturb. Check the schedule for a night-time auto-start and cancel it.
  ```

- [ ] **5.2** Turn off Focus mode, which is a separate feature in a different place and is easy to forget.

  ```
  Settings → Digital Wellbeing & parental controls → Focus mode → Turn off now
  Also check for a Schedule and switch that off. Focus mode pauses apps entirely — it does not merely mute them.
  ```

- [ ] **5.3** Let the app's notifications override Do Not Disturb, so that even if a mode is switched on later by accident, the gateway still gets through.

  ```
  Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → Notifications → Override Do Not Disturb
  ```

- [ ] **5.4** **One more that catches people:** notifications are split into categories, and the master switch can be on while the specific category your gateway uses is off. Open the app's **Notifications** screen, turn on **every** category listed underneath, and set the important one to **High** importance.

6 Restart the phone

- [ ] **6.1** Turn the phone off and on again. Android re-evaluates every app's restrictions at boot, and a restart guarantees the exemptions you just set are actually in force. This step is not optional — without it some brands keep the old rules until the next reboot.

Now find your phone's brand below. Sections 1 to 6 each cover the same five jobs in your manufacturer's own wording: excluding the app from battery optimisation, allowing it to start by itself, taking it out of any sleep or restriction list, granting every permission, and the specific trap that brand uses.

SECTION 01 · GALAXY PHONES

Samsung — One UI

One UI 5, 6 run Android 13–14 · **One UI 7, 8** run Android 15–16. Samsung moved the menus between these, so both are given below. Look at the pair of paths in each step and use the one that matches what is on your screen.

1 Exclude the app from battery optimisation

UNRESTRICTED

- [ ] **1.1** Open the app's own page and set it to **Unrestricted**. This is the single most important setting on a Samsung phone.

  `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → Battery → Unrestricted`

  You will see three choices: **Restricted**, **Optimised** and **Unrestricted**. **Restricted** is the most dangerous — it stops the app running in the background at all. Choose **Unrestricted**.

- [ ] **1.2** **If your build does not offer Unrestricted here,** reach the same setting from the battery graph instead: **Settings → Battery** (or **Battery and device care → Battery**) → tap the app in the usage graph → **Limit usage** → **Unrestricted**.

2 Allow the app to start by itself after a restart

Samsung has no switch called "Autostart". What it has instead is the default messaging app role from Section 0, plus the sleep-list exemption in step 3. Make sure the app is the default messaging app, because that is what lets it come back on its own after the phone boots.

- [ ] **2.1** Confirm the app is the default messaging app — Section 0, step 2.

  `Settings → Apps → Choose default apps → SMS app → your gateway app`

- [ ] **2.2** Confirm the app survives being closed. Open the recent-apps view (swipe up from the bottom and hold), find the gateway's card, and **swipe down on the card** until a padlock appears. On some One UI builds, tap the three dots on the card instead and choose **Lock**. A locked app is not closed when you swipe it away.

- [ ] **2.3** Turn off Samsung's overnight automation, which re-puts apps to sleep while you sleep.

  `Settings → Battery and device care → ⋮ (top right) → Automation → turn off Auto-optimise daily and Adaptive battery`
  `On One UI 7 and 8, Battery and device care may be simply Battery, and Adaptive battery may sit under the three-dot menu of the Battery screen instead.`

3 Take the app out of Samsung's sleeping lists

THE SAMSUNG-SPECIFIC TRAP

Samsung keeps its own two lists that sit *on top of* the standard Android battery rules. **Sleeping apps** have their background activity delayed or restricted. **Deep sleeping apps** never run in the background at all and show no notifications — they only work when you open them. An app can be marked Unrestricted and still be dumped into one of these lists, and the lists are populated automatically.

- [ ] **3.1** Open the background usage limits screen.

  ONE UI 7, 8 (Android 15–16)

  `Settings → Battery → Background usage limits`

  On these builds **Battery** moved to the top level of Settings and there is no **Battery and device care** entry.

  ONE UI 5, 6 (Android 13–14)

  `Settings → Battery and device care → Battery → Background usage limits`

- [ ] **3.2** **Turn OFF the master switch at the top:** **Put unused apps to sleep**. Leave this on and Samsung will put your app back on the sleeping list roughly three days later, undoing everything else you did. (On some builds it is worded **Put rarely used apps to sleep**.)

- [ ] **3.3** Open **Sleeping apps**. If your gateway app is listed, remove it: tap the three-dot menu ⋮ in the top right, tap **Remove apps** (on some builds **Edit apps**), tick the app, then tap **Remove** at the bottom.

- [ ] **3.4** Open **Deep sleeping apps** and remove the app the same way. **This is the more important of the two** — a deep sleeping app does not run in the background at all.

- [ ] **3.5** Now add the app to the exemption list. Tap **Never sleeping apps**, then the **+** or **Add** button, tick your gateway app, and tap **Add**.

  `Settings → Battery → Background usage limits → Never sleeping apps → + → tick app → Add`

  Some One UI versions and regions call this list **Never auto sleeping apps** and there may also be a separate **Never sleeping apps** entry. If you see both, put the app in both. A few builds label the top-right button **Add** rather than a **+**.

- [ ] **3.6** **If the app does not appear in that list, do not worry.** Once an app is set to **Unrestricted** in step 1, Samsung takes it out of sleep management automatically, so the list may show nothing and the app will not be offered for selection. That is the correct outcome, not a mistake. Only if the app *is* offered should you add it.

> ⚠ **Samsung's quiet overnight killer**
>
> Even with **Put unused apps to sleep** switched off, Samsung's **Auto-optimise daily** automation and **Adaptive battery** can move apps between lists on a nightly schedule, usually in the small hours — precisely the window where an OTP must go out. Switch both off in step 2.3, and re-check them after any major system update, because Samsung is known to restore them.

4 Grant every permission

- [ ] **4.1** Open the app's permissions screen and set each one to **Allow**.

  > `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → Permissions`

- [ ] **4.2** Set these to **Allow**: **SMS** (sometimes split into **Send SMS**, **Receive SMS** and **Read SMS**), **Phone**, **Contacts**, and **Notifications**. If the group is shown as one entry, **Phone and messages**, open it and allow each item inside. A greyed-out SMS switch means the app was sideloaded — go back to Section 0, step 4.

- [ ] **4.3** Also set the notification categories. Open the app's **Notifications** screen, confirm **All notifications** is on, and turn on each individual category beneath it — a master switch on with the important category off is a common cause of "no notification ever arrived".

5 Samsung's other traps

> ⚠ **Five things that will quietly undo your work**
>
> - **Power saving mode.** **Settings → Battery → Power saving mode**. If it is on, it overrides your exemptions. Turn it off and set the trigger to never.
> - **Adaptive battery.** Samsung's version of Adaptive Battery. Off, per step 2.3.
> - **Deep sleeping apps.** The list that stops background running entirely. Not something you notice, because the app still opens when you tap it.
> - **Settings revert after updates.** A large One UI upgrade has been reported to restore the sleep lists and the optimisation settings to their defaults. Re-run Section 1 and Section 3 after every major update.
> - **Memory cleaner.** **Settings → Device care → Memory**. If the app is listed under apps to be cleared, exclude it. Some One UI builds also have an **Excluded apps** list you can add it to.

SECTION 02 · REDMI, POCO, XIAOMI

Xiaomi — MIUI and HyperOS

MIUI 12–14 covers Android 12–14 · **HyperOS 1–3** covers Android 14–16. Xiaomi inherited almost all of MIUI's background logic in HyperOS, so the instructions largely match; only the wording and the location changed. **HyperOS is the most aggressive background-killer of any phone in this guide** — do not skip this section.

1 Exclude the app from battery optimisation

NO RESTRICTIONS

- [ ] **1.1** Set the app to **No restrictions**.

MIUI 12–14	`Settings → Apps → Manage apps → your gateway app → Battery saver → No restrictions`
HYPEROS 1–3	`Settings → Apps → your gateway app → Battery → No restrictions`

If the app is not listed under **Manage apps**, tap the search icon at the top of the Apps screen and type its name. If the app does not show a **Battery saver** entry at all, use the Security app route in step 1.2 instead.

- [ ] **1.2** **The route that works on every Xiaomi:** use the built-in Security app.

```
Security app → Battery → App battery saver → your gateway app → No restrictions
```

Some HyperOS builds also expose this at **Settings → Battery & performance → App battery saver**, and under **Additional settings → Battery manager → Activity control**.

2 Turn on Autostart

THE SETTING THAT DECIDES EVERYTHING

This is the one that matters on Xiaomi. The autostart switch is **off by default** for every app you install. With it off, when MIUI or HyperOS frees the app's memory, the app is not allowed to start itself again — it sits dead until a human taps it. A gateway app that cannot restart itself is useless at 3am.

- [ ] **2.1** Find the Autostart screen and switch your gateway app on.

HYPEROS 2–3	`Settings → Apps → Permissions → Background autostart → your gateway app → toggle ON`
MIUI 14	`Settings → Apps → Manage apps → Background autostart → your gateway app → toggle ON` `On some builds you go to the app's own page instead: Manage apps → your app → App permissions → Background autostart.`
MIUI 12–13	`Security app → Permissions → Autostart → your gateway app → toggle ON` If **Autostart** is not listed, try **Security → Permissions → Other permissions** and look for **Autostart**, or **Security → App management → Autostart**.

- [ ] **2.2** **While you are in the Autostart screen,** turn on **both** switches the app may show — typically **Autostart** and **Secondary launch**. Secondary launch is what allows the app to be woken by another app, such as your server. Also check the app's own page for a switch called **Start in background** under **Other permissions** and allow it.

- [ ] **2.3** **Protect the app from the memory cleaner.** Two separate things:

```
A) Lock it in recent apps — swipe up from the bottom and hold, then swipe down on the gateway's card until a padlock appears
B) Security app → Boost speed → Settings (top right) → Lock apps → tick your gateway app
```

On HyperOS there is also **Settings → Additional settings → Battery manager → Protected apps** — add the gateway there too if that screen exists.

> ⚠ **The trap: two switches, and only doing one**
>
> **No restrictions** and **Autostart** are completely separate settings with separate purposes. **No restrictions** stops the system from restricting the app. **Autostart** permits the app to start itself after being killed or after a restart. A gateway with only the first will keep working until MIUI frees its memory, and then go silent until someone taps the icon. Set both. Always both.

3 Sleeping and restricted lists

Xiaomi does not publish a "Sleeping apps" list the way Samsung does. The equivalent restriction lives in the per-app **Battery saver** setting from step 1, and the app's sleep state is also controlled by the **Autostart** switch from step 2. A Xiaomi app can show as running yet be denied background execution; that is the state step 1 removes.

- [ ] **3.1** Confirm step 1 and step 2 are both done for this app. On a Xiaomi, that single check replaces the whole "sleeping apps" list other brands have.

- [ ] **3.2** If your build exposes a list, it is usually called **Battery restricted apps** or **App battery saver**, and it is inside the Security app's **Battery** section or **Settings → Battery & performance**. The gateway app must not be in it.

```
Security app → Battery → App battery saver → check the list
```

- [ ] **3.3** **Set the system power profile to maximum,** so the chip is not throttled while the app is working.

```
Settings → Additional settings → Battery manager → Power plan → Performance
Or on HyperOS: Settings → Battery & performance → Battery manager → Power plan → Performance.
```

4 Grant every permission

- [ ] **4.1** Open the app's permissions and set every entry to **Allow**.

  ```
  Settings → Apps → Manage apps → your gateway app → App permissions
  On HyperOS, the shorter route is Settings → Apps → your gateway app → Permissions.
  ```

  - [ ] **4.2** Allow **SMS** (or the split **Send SMS** / **Receive SMS** / **Read SMS** entries), **Phone**, **Contacts** and **Notifications**. A greyed-out switch means the app was sideloaded — Section 0, step 4.
  - [ ] **4.3** Turn on every notification category in the app's **Notifications** screen and set the important one to **High** importance.

5 Xiaomi's other traps

> ⚠ **Five things that will quietly undo your work**
>
> - **Autostart is off by default** and stays off until you turn it on. This is the number-one cause of "the gateway stopped after a restart" on Xiaomi phones.
> - **The Security app's memory cleaner.** **Security → Boost speed** kills background apps. The **Lock apps** list in step 2.3 protects yours.
> - **MIUI's aggressive memory killer.** Even with the right settings, MIUI can unload an app to save RAM. This is the behaviour that makes the Autostart switch non-negotiable.
> - **Power saver mode.** **Settings → Battery & performance → Power saving**. Turn it off, and add the app to **Exceptions** if such a list exists.
> - **Autostart can be revoked later.** Xiaomi has been known to switch autostart back off for apps it decides are unused, and to re-apply restrictions after a system update. Re-check steps 1 and 2 monthly — Section 7 has a checklist.

SECTION 03 · OPPO, REALME, ONEPLUS

Oppo and Realme — ColorOS

ColorOS 11–12 (Android 11–12) · **ColorOS 13–14** (Android 13–14) · **ColorOS 15–16** (Android 15–16). Realme runs **realme UI** on the same foundation, so the steps are identical; only the words differ. OnePlus also shares this section.

1 Exclude the app from battery optimisation

DON'T OPTIMISE

- [ ] **1.1** Open the app's battery page and allow background activity and auto launch.

COLOROS 13–16	`Settings → Apps → App management → your gateway app → Battery usage`
ALL VERSIONS	`Settings → Battery → App battery management → your gateway app` On some builds this is behind the three-dot menu of the Battery screen, or under **Power saving → App battery management**.

- [ ] **1.2** On that screen, turn **on** every switch the app shows:

  - **Allow background activity** — on older ColorOS this is worded **Allow background running** or **Run in background**.
  - **Allow auto launch** — on some realme builds this reads **Allow auto startup**.
  - **Allow foreground activity** — present on realme UI and ColorOS 15, and it matters: without it the app is stopped when the screen goes off.
  - **Allow this app to launch other apps** — only if your gateway is woken by another app.

  If a switch reads **Smart control** or **Optimise** instead, turn it **off** — that is the restrictive setting.

- [ ] **1.3** **Also set the top-level "don't optimise" flag**, which is a separate gate from the switches above.

  `Settings → Battery → More settings → Optimise battery use → your gateway app → Don't optimise`

  Spelling varies by region: **Optimise battery use** / **Optimize battery use**, and **Don't optimise** / **Don't optimize**.

2 Allow the app to start by itself

AUTO LAUNCH

ColorOS keeps an explicit list of apps permitted to start themselves. A gateway not on that list cannot come back after a restart or after being killed.

- [ ] **2.1** Open the auto-launch list and turn the gateway on.

COLOROS 15–16	`Settings → Apps → Auto launch → your gateway app → toggle ON`
COLOROS 13–14	`Settings → Apps → App management → Auto launch → your gateway app → toggle ON` `If it is not there, use the Phone Manager app: Phone Manager → Privacy permissions → Startup manager.`
COLOROS 11–12, REALME UI 4–5	`Settings → App management → Auto launch` `Or Phone Manager → Privacy permissions → Startup manager.`

- [ ] **2.2** **Check for a second switch** called **Associated launch** or **Secondary launch**, and turn it on. It is what lets another app start the gateway.

- [ ] **2.3** Lock the app in the recent-apps view — swipe up from the bottom and hold, find the gateway's card, and swipe **down** on it (or tap its three dots and choose **Lock**) until a padlock shows.

> ⚠ **The trap: a five-app limit**
>
> On ColorOS 15 the **Auto launch** list holds only a handful of apps — five is the number most often reported. If the gateway is not in the list, or the list is full, it cannot be added. Work around it by removing apps you genuinely do not need from the list, and confirm the gateway's position each month. If your build offers a priority setting on the list, give the gateway the highest priority.

3 Turn off the standby optimisation that sleeps apps overnight

THE COLOROS-SPECIFIC TRAP

ColorOS has a feature that puts the whole phone into a low-power standby state while it is idle — usually overnight — which reduces how often push notifications arrive. It is on by default and is a genuine overnight hazard for a gateway.

- [ ] **3.1** Find and turn it off.

COLOROS 15–16	`Settings → Battery → Power saving → Sleep standby optimization → turn OFF`
REALME UI 6–7	`Settings → Battery → Power saving settings → Sleep standby optimization → turn OFF`
REALME UI 5 AND BELOW	`Settings → Battery → More settings / Advanced settings → Optimized standby → Ultra standby mode → turn OFF`

If the switch is not where this says, search the Settings screen for **standby** — that lands you on the right screen faster than hunting.

- [ ] **3.2** Turn off the phone-wide power saving modes as well: **Settings → Battery → Power saving mode** and, if present, **Super Power Saving** / **Super power saving mode**. ColourOS's super power saving mode is severe — it can stop apps entirely.

- [ ] **3.3** ColourOS has no user-facing "sleeping apps" list. The combination in steps 1 and 2 — background activity, auto launch, foreground activity, and "Don't optimise" — is the whole of its background control, and all four must be set.

4 Grant every permission

- [ ] **4.1** Open the app's permissions and set each to **Allow**.

  > `Settings → Apps → App management → your gateway app → App permissions`

- [ ] **4.2** Allow **SMS** (or the split **Send SMS** / **Receive SMS** / **Read SMS**), **Phone**, **Contacts** and **Notifications**. A greyed-out switch means the app was sideloaded — Section 0, step 4.

- [ ] **4.3** Turn on every notification category in the app's **Notifications** screen, and switch on **Allow background pop-up** if that option exists — on ColorOS it is what allows the app to raise a message over whatever is on screen.

5 ColorOS's other traps

> ⚠ **Five things that will quietly undo your work**
>
> - **Sleep standby optimisation** — the overnight deep sleep in step 3.1. On by default on ColorOS 15 and realme UI 6.
> - **The five-app auto-launch cap** — a limit, not a preference. If the gateway is missing from the list, this is why.
> - **"Optimise" vs "Don't optimise"** — two different screens. Both must say the friendly thing.
> - **Super Power Saving mode** — not the same as normal power saving, and much more aggressive.
> - **Swiping the app away.** ColourOS kills recent apps aggressively unless the card is locked. Lock it in step 2.3, and never use a one-tap "clear all" button on this phone.

SECTION 04 · VIVO, IQOO

Vivo — Funtouch OS

Funtouch OS 9–12 cover Android 9–12 · **Funtouch OS 13–15** cover Android 13–15. iQOO phones use **OriginOS**, which is the same system with different wording. Some controls moved from the old **i Manager** app into Settings over the years, so both are given.

1 Exclude the app from battery optimisation

UNRESTRICTED

- [ ] **1.1** Set the app to **Unrestricted** on its own page. This is available from Android 13 onwards.

  `Settings → Apps → your gateway app → Battery → Unrestricted`

  - [ ] **1.2** **Then, and this is the one that matters most on Vivo,** allow high background power consumption.

FUNTOUCH OS 3.0+	`Settings → Battery → High background power consumption → turn your gateway app ON`
ANDROID 13+ BUILDS	`Settings → Battery → Background power consumption management → your gateway app → High background power usage / allow`
FUNTOUCH OS BELOW 3.0	`i Manager app → Power manager → Excessive background battery usage → allow your gateway app`

    Vivo's own rule is blunt: an app that burns background power will be closed to save power unless it is on this list. A gateway deliberately runs in the background, so it is exactly the app that gets closed.

  - [ ] **1.3** Turn off Vivo's smart power saving for this app.

    `Settings → Battery → Smart Power Saving → turn your gateway app OFF`

    If **Smart Power Saving** is not listed, look for **Power saving strategy** or **Background power consumption**.

2 Allow the app to start by itself

AUTOSTART

- [ ] **2.1** Turn on the autostart switch.

FUNTOUCH OS 3.0+	`Settings → More settings → Applications → Autostart → your gateway app → toggle ON` Vivo's own help also gives the route **Settings → More settings → Permission management (Applications) → Autostart**. Try that if the first does not show it.
FUNTOUCH OS 2.6 AND BELOW	`i Manager app → App manager → Autostart manager → your gateway app → toggle ON`

- [ ] **2.2** **Add the app to Vivo's whitelist,** which is its "do not clear me" list. This is a separate thing from autostart and is what protects the app from the one-tap "Speed up" button.

FROM I MANAGER	`i Manager app → Settings icon (top right) → Speedup whitelist → turn your gateway app ON`
FROM THE APP ICON	`Open the gateway app → swipe up to the Control Center → long-press the app's icon → Add to white list`

- [ ] **2.3** Lock the app in the recent-apps view: swipe up from the bottom and hold, find the gateway's card, swipe **down** on it (or tap its three dots and choose **Lock**) until a padlock shows.

- [ ] **2.4** **If your build has it,** allow background operation under special access: **Settings → Apps → Special access → Background operation**.

3 Sleeping and restricted lists

Vivo does not publish a "Sleeping apps" list. Its equivalent is the combination already covered: the app must be **Unrestricted**, must be on the **High background power consumption** list, must have **Autostart** on, and must be on the **Speedup whitelist**. Missing any one of the four produces the same symptom — the gateway goes quiet for a few hours and then comes back.

- [ ] **3.1** Re-confirm all four from steps 1 and 2. If the phone is on a dual network, also check that data saving is not throttling it:

  `Settings → Mobile network → Data-saving mode → add your gateway app to the Whitelist (Funtouch OS 3.1 and newer)`

4 Grant every permission

- [ ] **4.1** Open the app's permissions and set each to **Allow**.

  `Settings → Apps → your gateway app → Permissions`

- [ ] **4.2** Allow **SMS** (or **Send SMS** / **Receive SMS** / **Read SMS**), **Phone**, **Contacts** and **Notifications**. A greyed-out switch means the app was sideloaded — Section 0, step 4.

- [ ] **4.3** Turn on every notification category in the app's **Notifications** screen, and set the important one to a high importance level. If **Allow background pop-up** is offered, turn it on.

5 Vivo's other traps

> ⚠ **Five things that will quietly undo your work**
>
> - **The "Speed up" button.** Vivo's control panel has a one-tap `Speed up` that closes everything running. The `Speedup whitelist` in step 2.2 is the only thing standing between your gateway and that button.
> - **Background power consumption.** Vivo closes apps it judges to be draining power, whatever you set elsewhere. This list is mandatory for a gateway.
> - **Autostart off by default**, and the setting can be reset by a system update.
> - **Smart Power Saving** overrides the whitelist in some builds.
> - **Data-saving mode** throttles background network use, which can make a gateway that works look like it has stopped.

SECTION 05 · GOOGLE PIXEL

Google Pixel — stock Android 13 / 14

A Pixel is the closest thing to a plain Android phone, which makes it the easiest to set up correctly — but Google ships **Adaptive Battery** switched **on** by default, and it is the setting most likely to strangle a gateway.

1 Exclude the app from battery optimisation

UNRESTRICTED

- [ ] **1.1** Open the app's battery page and set it to **Unrestricted**.

  `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → App battery usage → Allow background usage → Unrestricted`

  The wording moves with the version. On Android 14 and some earlier builds you must first turn the **Allow background usage** switch **on**, then tap it **again** to reveal the choice underneath. From Android 14 QPR2 the screen was redesigned so **Optimised** and **Unrestricted** appear directly as two buttons. On Android 13 the menu is simply called **Battery** instead of **App battery usage**.

- [ ] **1.2** **Also set the phone-wide optimisation list,** which is a separate screen and can override the per-app one.

BATTERY SCREEN ROUTE	`Settings → Battery → ⋮ (three dots, top right) → Battery optimization → tap the drop-down showing Not optimized and choose All apps → tap your gateway app → Don't optimize → Done`
SPECIAL ACCESS ROUTE	`Settings → Apps → ⋮ → Special app access → Battery optimization → drop-down All apps → tap your gateway app → Don't optimize → Done`

  If you cannot find either route, search the Settings search bar for **battery optimization** and open the screen directly.

2 Turn off Adaptive Battery

ON BY DEFAULT ON EVERY PIXEL

Google's Adaptive Battery watches how you use your phone and quietly pushes apps you rarely open into a "Rare" or "Never" bucket, where they get almost no background work. On a phone dedicated to one gateway app, this is exactly backwards. It is on by default, so you must turn it off.

- [ ] **2.1** Switch it off.

ANDROID 14+	`Settings → Battery → Adaptive Battery → turn OFF Use Adaptive Battery`
ANDROID 13	`Settings → Battery → Battery Saver → Adaptive Battery → Expand more → turn OFF Use Adaptive Battery`

- [ ] **2.2** **Turn off Battery Saver** and make sure it cannot switch itself on at low battery: **Settings → Battery → Battery Saver** → off, and **Battery Saver** → **Battery Saver suggestions** / **Automatic Battery Saver** → off.

- [ ] **2.3** **There is no "autostart" switch on a Pixel** and it does not need one. The equivalents are: the app is the default messaging app (Section 0, step 2), it is set to **Unrestricted**, and it is not paused as unused (Section 0, step 3). A locked card in the recent-apps view is a useful extra.

3 Take the app out of the unused-app lists

A Pixel has no "sleeping apps" list. It has two Android-level equivalents, and both are worth setting.

- [ ] **3.1** **Hibernation — the important one.** Section 0, step 3 covers this in full: **Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app**, scroll to the bottom, and under **Unused app settings** turn **off** **Pause app activity if unused**.

- [ ] **3.2** **The unused-apps list itself.** Go to **Settings → Apps** and tap **Unused apps** at the bottom of that screen. Your gateway should not be on it. If it is, tap it and turn **Pause app activity if unused** off.

- [ ] **3.3** **Do Not Disturb, Bedtime, Driving and Focus mode** — Section 0, step 5. On a Pixel these live at **Settings → Modes** and **Settings → Digital Wellbeing & parental controls → Focus mode**. Check each mode's **Notification filters → Apps** list as well, since an app can be filtered out there without the mode being obviously on.

4 Grant every permission

- [ ] **4.1** Open the app's permissions and set each to **Allow**.

  `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → Permissions`

- [ ] 4.2 Allow **SMS** (or **Send SMS** / **Receive SMS** / **Read SMS**), **Phone**, **Contacts** and **Notifications**. A greyed-out switch means the app was sideloaded — Section 0, step 4, and note that this is the single most common cause of a gateway failing on a Pixel.
- [ ] 4.3 Turn on every notification category and set **Override Do Not Disturb** on the app's **Notifications** screen.

5 Pixel and stock Android traps

> ⚠ **Five things that will quietly undo your work**
>
> - **Adaptive Battery** — on by default, and it targets precisely the apps you never open. Step 2.1.
> - **Hibernation.** After a few months of not opening the app, Android force-stops it, resets its permissions and silences its notifications. This is the failure that arrives months later, when you are not looking.
> - **Notification categories.** The master switch can be on while the one category your gateway uses is off.
> - **Notification permission declined at install time.** Since Android 13 the app must be allowed notifications separately, and if that prompt was dismissed with "Don't allow", the dialog never comes back on its own — you have to go and enable it by hand.
> - **Data Saver.** **Settings → Network & internet → Data Saver**. Off for a dedicated gateway phone, or add the app to the exempt list.

SECTION 06 · EVERYTHING ELSE

Any other Android 13 / 14 phone

Motorola, Nokia, Honor, Asus, Nothing, Sony, OnePlus on OxygenOS, and every other handset that is not a Samsung, Xiaomi, Oppo/Realme, Vivo or Pixel. The menu names below are the standard Android ones, lightly reworded by most brands. If your phone has one of the brand sections above, use that instead — it will be more accurate.

1 Exclude the app from battery optimisation

UNRESTRICTED

- [ ] **1.1** Set the app to **Unrestricted** on its own page.

  `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → App battery usage → Allow background usage → Unrestricted`

  The menu is called **App battery usage** on Android 14 and **Battery** on Android 13. On some builds you must turn the **Allow background usage** switch on first, then tap it again to reveal the choice.

- [ ] **1.2** **Also set the phone-wide optimisation list.** This one screen covers every app at once and is often missed.

  `Settings → Battery → ⋮ (three dots) → Battery optimization → drop-down Not optimized → choose All apps → tap your gateway app → Don't optimize → Done`
  `Alternate route: Settings → Apps → ⋮ → Special app access → Battery optimization.`

2 Allow the app to start by itself

Most other Android brands have no autostart switch, and the app starts itself as normal. Two things do the job: the default messaging app role, and the developer option below.

- [ ] **2.1** Make the app the default messaging app if it can be — Section 0, step 2.

  `Settings → Apps → Default apps → SMS app → your gateway app`

- [ ] **2.2** **Raise the background process limit,** which some brands set low. You must switch on the developer menu first: go to **Settings → About phone** and tap **Build number** seven times, then tap **Enter PIN**. Back in Settings, a new **Developer options** entry appears.

  `Settings → Developer options → Background process limit → choose No limit (some builds label it No background processes — pick whichever option allows the most)`

- [ ] **2.3** **Make sure two neighbouring switches are OFF,** because they will kill a gateway outright. In the same **Developer options** screen: **Don't keep activities** must be **off** (if on, the app is destroyed the moment you leave it), and **Background process limit** must not be set to a restrictive value.

- [ ] **2.4** Lock the app in the recent-apps view: swipe up from the bottom and hold, find the gateway's card, swipe **down** on it until a padlock appears.

3 Take the app out of the sleeping and restricted lists

- [ ] **3.1** **Hibernation and the unused-app list** — Section 0, step 3 and Section 5, step 3. These are the standard Android equivalents of a "sleeping apps" list and they are the ones that matter:

  `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → Unused app settings → Pause app activity if unused → turn OFF`

- [ ] **3.2** If your brand does have a named sleep list, it is usually under the battery settings as **App standby**, **Standby**, **Sleeping apps** or **Deep sleeping apps**. Search the Settings search bar for **sleep** — that is faster than navigating. Remove the gateway from any list it appears in, and if there is a "never sleep" or exemption list, add it there.

- [ ] **3.3** Turn off the phone-wide battery saver and data saver, both of which sit above the per-app settings and override them.

  `Settings → Battery → Battery Saver → off`
  `Settings → → Network & internet → Data Saver → off`

4 Grant every permission

- [ ] **4.1** Open the app's permissions and set each to **Allow**.

  `Settings → Apps → See all apps → your gateway app → Permissions`

- [ ] **4.2** Allow **SMS** (or **Send SMS** / **Receive SMS** / **Read SMS**), **Phone**, **Contacts** and **Notifications**. A greyed-out switch means the app was sideloaded — Section 0, step 4.

- [ ] **4.3** Turn on every notification category in the app's **Notifications** screen and set **Override Do Not Disturb**.

5 Traps on lesser-known brands

⚠ **Five things that will quietly undo your work**

- **Some brands ship their own "app sleeping" feature** under an unexpected name — a "Smart app control", "App manager" or "Cool app" style screen. Search the Settings search bar for `sleep`, `background` and `autostart` and check every result.
- **Honor and Huawei phones** have their own app-launch and background controls, and they sit under `App launch` and `App power management` rather than the Android defaults. Treat them like the Xiaomi section.
- **Asus and Nothing** ship an aggressive background limiter of their own. Look for `App battery management` or `Background restrictions` and set the app to unrestricted.
- **OnePlus on OxygenOS** behaves much like ColorOS and is closer to Section 3 than to generic Android.
- **Every brand's "phone manager" app** — a separate app from Settings, often named Phone Manager, Device Care, Security or Smart Manager — has its own one-tap "optimise" button. Find it once and either stop using that button on this phone or add the gateway to its protected list.

SECTION 07

Prove it works, then keep it working

Settings drift. Phones get updated, brands re-apply their defaults, and some of these switches quietly reset themselves. A ten-minute routine keeps the problem away.

1 The reboot test — five minutes, do it today

This proves the whole configuration in one go. It catches the two most common failures: the app not starting by itself, and the app starting but not being allowed to work in the background.

- [ ] 1.1 Send one test message through the gateway, so you know it works right now. Note the exact time it arrived.
- [ ] 1.2 Reboot the phone. Do not open the gateway app afterwards.
- [ ] 1.3 Wait about ten minutes. Then send a second test message from the server side.
- [ ] 1.4 **The message arrived within a few seconds?** Your phone is correctly configured.
- [ ] 1.5 **The message never arrived?** The app did not start by itself. Go back and check the autostart step for your brand — Section 2, step 2.1 for Xiaomi; Section 3, step 2.1 for Oppo/Realme; Section 4, step 2.1 for Vivo; Section 0, step 2 for everything else.
- [ ] 1.6 **The message arrived late — say, twenty minutes?** The app started but was throttled. Re-check the battery optimisation step and the sleep-list step for your brand, and confirm the phone is on the charger.

2 The monthly five-minute check

Brands quietly undo these settings more often than anyone admits. A short monthly routine is cheaper than an outage you did not notice. Open the gateway app once — that alone resets the "unused" clock — and then:

- [ ] 2.1 Confirm the battery setting is still unrestricted. Samsung: **Settings → Apps → your app → Battery**. Xiaomi: **Battery saver → No restrictions**. Oppo/Realme: **Battery usage → Allow background activity**. Vivo: **High background power consumption**. Pixel: **App battery usage → Unrestricted**.
- [ ] 2.2 Confirm autostart is still on. Xiaomi: **Background autostart**. Oppo/Realme: **Auto launch**. Vivo: **Autostart**.
- [ ] 2.3 Confirm the phone is still paused-free: **Pause app activity if unused** is off, and the app is not listed under **Unused apps**.
- [ ] 2.4 On Samsung, re-check **Background usage limits** and confirm the app is not back in the sleeping or deep sleeping list. Also confirm **Auto-optimise daily** is still off.
- [ ] 2.5 Confirm the phone is still on the charger and the battery is not being held at 80% by an adaptive-charging setting.

3 After any system update

A major Android update can restore the brand's default battery settings, reset the sleep lists, and re-lock the permissions if the app was sideloaded. Treat every large update as if the phone were new: re-run your brand section, then the reboot test.

- [ ] 3.1 Re-run the battery-optimisation step, the autostart step, and the sleep-list step for your brand. On Android 15 and 16, also re-check the SMS permission — it can return to greyed-out.
- [ ] 3.2 Re-run the reboot test. This is the only way to know for certain.

4 One more setting worth knowing about

If your gateway app is written by someone else, ask them one question: **does it run as a foreground service?** A foreground service is a service that keeps running with a permanent small notification. Android is far less likely to kill one, and it is exempt from the background limits you have been removing. If the app supports it, switch it on in the app's own settings — it is usually labelled something like **Keep alive**, **Run in background**, **Start on boot** or **Persistent service**.

> ⚠ **If the app was written for Android 15 or newer**
>
> Android 15 capped the time a background "data sync" foreground service may run at **six hours in any 24-hour period**, after which the system stops it. An app that uses this service type for its polling will be cut off roughly every six hours unless it was written to handle that. If your gateway stops at a suspiciously regular interval — every six hours, like clockwork — that is this limit, not a battery setting. The fix is in the app, not in Settings: it needs a different service type, or to restart cleanly when it is handed a timeout.

SECTION 08

Symptom finder

Start from what you observed, not from what you think caused it. The left column is the symptom; the right column is where to look.

1 What you saw, and where to look

WHAT YOU NOTICED	MOST LIKELY CAUSE	WHERE TO FIX IT
Nothing at all is sent, ever	The SMS permission is not granted, or the app cannot start itself after a reboot	Section 0 step 4 (restricted settings), your brand's autostart step, and confirm the app is the default messaging app
Works when you open the app, silent when you don't	The app is asleep and Android will not wake it	Battery optimisation set to Unrestricted, plus the sleep-list step for your brand
Fine for a few days, then stops	Android hibernated the app because you never opened it, and reset its permissions	Section 0 step 3 — turn off **Pause app activity if unused**, and open the app monthly
Fine for a few months, then stops	The same hibernation problem, which takes a few months to trigger	Exactly as above. This one catches almost everyone eventually
Stops every night, works in the daytime	An overnight standby or automation feature	Samsung **Auto-optimise daily**; Oppo/Realme **Sleep standby optimization**; Xiaomi power saving
Stops at exactly six-hour intervals	The Android 15 data-sync foreground service limit	An app-side problem — see Section 7, step 4
Stops only when the phone is unplugged	Android's sleep mode, which does not engage while charging	Put the phone back on the charger — Section 0, step 1
No notification, but messages do send	A notification category is off, or the notification permission was declined	App info → Notifications → turn on every category; Section 0, step 5.4
The SMS permission button is greyed out	The app was installed from an APK, and Android is blocking restricted permissions	Section 0, step 4 — critical on Android 15 and 16
It stopped after a system update	The update reset the brand's battery and sleep settings	Re-run your brand section, then the reboot test — Section 7, step 3
It works on Wi-Fi but not on mobile data	Data Saver, or a data-saving mode on the brand	Turn off **Data Saver**; Vivo's **Data-saving mode** whitelist

If a step in this guide does not match your phone, search the Settings screen for the bold word in the step — the Settings search bar on every brand jumps straight to the right screen. A missing menu almost always means your software version does not have that feature, so skip it rather than hunting for it.

PRINT THIS PAGE · ONE PAGE, ALL SIX BRANDS

The four taps that matter most

If you only have five minutes, do these four things for your brand. They cover the large majority of failures. Everything else in this guide is refinement.

Samsung · One UI 5–8

Galaxy · Android 13–16

1. Settings → Apps → See all apps → **your app** → Battery → **Unrestricted**
2. Settings → **Battery** (One UI 7/8) or **Battery and device care** (One UI 5/6) → Battery → **Background usage limits** → turn **off** "Put unused apps to sleep"
3. Same screen → **Sleeping apps** and **Deep sleeping apps** → remove your app from both
4. Same screen → **Never sleeping apps** (or "Never auto sleeping apps") → **+** → add your app. Then Device care → ⋮ → Automation → turn **off** "Auto-optimise daily"

Xiaomi · MIUI 12–14 / HyperOS 1–3

Redmi, POCO · Android 12–16

1. Settings → Apps → **Manage apps** → your app → **Battery saver** → **No restrictions**
2. Settings → Apps → **Background autostart** → your app → **ON** (on MIUI 12/13, use Security → Permissions → Autostart)
3. Settings → **Additional settings** → **Battery manager** → **Protected apps** → add your app (if the screen exists)
4. Security → **Boost speed** → Settings → **Lock apps** → tick your app. Then lock the app's card in Recent Apps with a swipe down

Oppo / Realme · ColorOS 11–16

OnePlus too · Android 11–16

1. Settings → Apps → **App management** → your app → **Battery usage** → turn on **Allow background activity** and **Allow auto launch** (and **Allow foreground activity** if shown)
2. Settings → Apps → **Auto launch** → your app → **ON**
3. Settings → Battery → **More settings** → **Optimise battery use** → your app → **Don't optimise**
4. Settings → Battery → **Power saving** → turn **off** "Sleep standby optimization". Then lock the app's card in Recent Apps

Vivo · Funtouch OS 9–15

iQOO too · Android 9–15

1. Settings → **More settings** → **Applications** → **Autostart** → your app → **ON**
2. Settings → **Battery** → **High background power consumption** (or "Background power consumption management") → your app → **ON**
3. i Manager → **Settings** icon (top right) → **Speedup whitelist** → your app → **ON**
4. Settings → Apps → your app → **Battery** → **Unrestricted**. Then lock the app's card in Recent Apps

Google Pixel · stock Android 13 / 14

Pixel 6 and newer

1. Settings → Apps → **See all apps** → your app → **App battery usage** → Allow background usage → **Unrestricted**
2. Settings → **Battery** → **Adaptive Battery** → turn **OFF** "Use Adaptive Battery"
3. Settings → Apps → **See all apps** → your app → **Unused app settings** → turn **OFF** "Pause app activity if unused"
4. Settings → Apps → **Default apps** → **SMS app** → your app. Then lock the app's card in Recent Apps

Any other Android 13 / 14 phone

Motorola, Nokia, Honor, Asus, Nothing, Sony, OnePlus OxygenOS

1. Settings → Apps → **See all apps** → your app → **App battery usage** → Allow background usage → **Unrestricted**
2. Settings → Apps → **See all apps** → your app → **Unused app settings** → turn **OFF** "Pause app activity if unused"
3. Settings → Apps → **Default apps** → **SMS app** → your app
4. Settings → **Developer options** → **Background process limit** → **No limit**, and make sure "Don't keep activities" is **off**

And for every phone, without exception

1. **Keep the phone plugged in.** Android's sleep mode does not engage while charging. This alone removes the largest cause of overnight delays.
2. **Turn off Do Not Disturb, Bedtime, Driving and Focus mode** — Section 0, step 5.
3. **Open the gateway app once a month** so Android never decides you have abandoned it.
4. **Never use a one-tap "clear all" or "optimise" button** on this phone, and never swipe the gateway's card away — lock it first.
5. **If the app was sideloaded**, do Section 0 step 4 or the SMS permission will never turn on.

Menu names drift between models, regions and software versions. When a name does not match, use the Settings search bar and type the bold word from the step — it lands on the correct screen. If a screen genuinely is not there, your version does not have that feature and you can skip it.